TrueNorth Brokerage Group LLC
d/b/a TrueNorth Property Management
Brokerage License CQ1075599 · Broker License BK3589651
7629 Odessa Ct, Brooksville, FL 34613
(352) 995-2355 · alfredo@truenorthpm.co · truenorthpm.co

Lease Signing Checklist

Use this for every tenancy. The lease is Florida Realtors/Florida Bar form RLHD-3×. TrueNorth fills in the blanks; TrueNorth does not draft lease language. If a landlord or tenant wants a term the form does not contain, send them to an attorney.

The signing packet

	Document	Notes
☐	**Nonlawyer disclosure (ND-3)**	One for the landlord, one for the tenant, whenever TrueNorth fills in blanks for them. Keep copies 6 years.
☐	**Residential Lease, RLHD-3×**	Completed from the data sheet. Every page initialed by landlord and tenant.
☐	**Early Termination Fee / Liquidated Damages Addendum**	Part of the form. Tenant chooses one of the two boxes — it cannot be left blank.
☐	**Lead-based paint disclosure and EPA pamphlet**	Required for any dwelling built before 1978. Article 13 of the lease, plus 'Protect Your Family From Lead in Your Home.'
☐	**Copy of Part II, Chapter 83, Florida Statutes**	Attached to the form. Hand it over with the lease; the lease says it is attached.
☐	**Homeowners' association documents and approval**	Rules, application, approval letter. Article 16 makes the lease contingent on approval.
☐	**Pet addendum**	Only if pets are permitted. Describe number, type, breed, and maximum adult weight in article 7.
☐	**Move-in condition report**	Completed with the tenant, dated and signed, with photos stored in the property file.
☐	**Keys and access receipt**	Counts must match article 12: dwelling keys, mailbox keys, openers, HOA keys, remotes, cards.
☐	**Proof of renter's insurance**	If required. Article 18 recommends it; it is not automatic.
☐	**Utility transfer confirmation**	Tenant's accounts active on the start date for everything article 9 does not assign to the landlord.
☐	**W-9 and insurance certificate from the owner**	For the management file, not the tenant packet.

After signing

	When	What
☐	**Within 30 days of receiving the deposit**	Send the tenant the written security deposit notice required by s. 83.49(3), Florida Statutes: where the deposit is held, whether it earns interest, and the surety bond details if any.
☐	**At signing**	Deliver a fully signed copy of the lease and every attachment to the tenant, and file one in the property folder.
☐	**Day one**	Deposits and advance rent into the brokerage property management escrow account. Never into an operating account.
☐	**Within 5 business days of the tenant getting phone service**	Article 25 requires the tenant to send their telephone number in writing. Chase it if it does not arrive.
☐	**Ongoing**	Keep the lease, addenda, disclosures, inspection reports, and ledgers for at least 5 years (s. 475.5015).

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Three things that go wrong most often

1. The early termination addendum is left blank. The tenant must pick one of the two boxes. A blank one is an argument waiting to happen.

2. The deposit notice is late. Section 83.49(3) gives you 30 days from receiving the deposit to tell the tenant in writing where it is held. Calendar it the day the money arrives.

3. Keys do not match article 12. Count them at move-in and write the same numbers on the lease and the keys receipt, or you cannot charge for what is missing at move-out.

Property _____

Tenant(s) _____

Lease start date _____

Packet assembled by / date _____